ADRECO CRM

Hosting Options: Office Server or Cloud

Can the CRM run in your office without internet, and what do we recommend?

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The short answer

Yes, it is possible. The CRM can run entirely on a server in your office with no internet connection. Staff can log in, upload photos and documents, and save data, all over the office network.

A cloud server cannot work without internet. Every phone and PC would need an internet connection just to open it.

Our recommendation: cloud hosting is the better option in general, and it is how almost all CRMs run today. An office server is the right choice only if the office has no internet and cannot get any.

1. How it works in your office

A server computer sits in your office and is connected to a router or switch. Staff open the CRM in their normal web browser at the server's local address (for example *http://192.168.1.10:3000*). All data, photos and documents are stored on the server's own disks. The router only needs to connect the devices to each other; no internet plan is required for daily work.

2. What works, and what needs internet

Works with no internet

- Login and role-based access
- Leads, department workflow and quotations
- Tasks and follow-ups
- Photo and document upload and download, stored on your server
- Dashboard and activity log

Needs internet (stays off in an offline setup)

- WhatsApp messaging and AI insights (not required)
- Zoho CRM sync and Zoho chat
- Automatic email reminders, unless you run your own mail server on the office network
- Using the CRM from outside the office (home, sites, mobile data)

Note: the current version of the CRM stores uploaded files in a cloud storage service. For an offline server, file storage has to be switched to the server's own disk, which needs a change to the software.

3. Office server or cloud: comparison

	Office server, no internet	Office server, with basic internet	Cloud server (India)
Works with no internet	Yes	Yes	No
Use from sites, home or phone	No	Possible, through a VPN	Yes, from anywhere
Remote support and updates	No, on-site visits only	Yes	Yes
Backups	Your backup disk only	Your disk plus an off-site copy	Automatic, off-site
Email reminders, Zoho	No	Yes	Yes
Hardware to look after	Yes	Yes	No
Control over your data	Full, stays in your building	Full, stays in your building	Held by a hosting provider
Ongoing cost	Electricity and upkeep	Internet line	Monthly hosting fee

4. Disadvantages of running the CRM on your own office server

- **One machine is a single point of failure.** A failed disk, a power cut, a power surge, a fire, theft or water damage can stop the whole team, or destroy the data.
- **Backups depend on people.** If nobody checks the backup disk, there may be nothing to restore. A backup kept in the same office is lost in the same fire or theft.
- **No access outside the office.** Sales and site teams cannot use the CRM at a customer's location, from home, or on a phone, unless a VPN and an internet line are added.
- **Someone has to maintain it.** The operating system, security updates, disk health and monitoring are the office's job. A server that is not kept updated becomes a security risk.
- **Slow, on-site support.** With no internet, problems cannot be fixed remotely. Every fix needs a site visit, and updates have to be carried in on a pen drive, so security fixes and new features arrive late.
- **Security is your responsibility.** Physical access to the server, the office network and the firewall are all managed by you, with no specialist monitoring.
- **Fewer features.** Email reminders, Zoho sync, WhatsApp and AI features do not work without internet, and any integration added later will have the same limit.
- **Upfront cost and ageing hardware.** You buy the server, UPS and backup disk at the start, and servers typically need to be replaced after a few years.
- **Growth means buying more hardware.** More users, more photos or more storage can mean a bigger server and a migration.
- **Recovery takes time.** If the server fails, a replacement has to be bought or repaired and the data restored, which can take days.

5. Why almost all CRMs today run on the cloud, and why it is better

Well-known CRM products, such as Zoho CRM, Salesforce and HubSpot, are delivered as cloud services. The reason is that the cloud removes the problems listed above.

- **Always available.** The servers sit in professional data centres with backup power, cooling and spare hardware. A failed disk or a power cut does not stop your team.
- **Automatic off-site backups.** Copies are kept away from your office, so a fire, theft or flood at the office does not destroy your data.
- **Access from anywhere.** Sales and site teams can use the CRM from a phone or laptop at a customer's location, and managers can check progress from home.
- **Security kept up to date.** Updates and security patches are applied quickly and continuously, by specialists, not left to the office.
- **Everything works together.** Email reminders, WhatsApp, Zoho and AI features all work because the system is online.
- **Remote support and quick updates.** Problems are fixed and new features released without a site visit.
- **No hardware to buy or replace.** You pay a monthly fee, and users or storage can be added at any time.

6. Our recommendation

> **General recommendation: cloud hosting.** Choose it if the office has internet, or can get it, and especially if any staff work outside the office. It can be hosted in India.

> **If the office has no internet and cannot get it:** an office server is the only option that works. In that case, a UPS and a daily backup to a separate disk are essential.

> **If you want your own server but can get a basic internet line:** keep the server in your office and connect it. That makes remote support, updates, an off-site backup copy and email reminders possible, and your data stays in your office.

7. What you need to provide for an office server

- **A server computer.** Suggested starting point for a small team of around 10 users: 4-core CPU, 16 GB RAM, two 500 GB SSDs mirrored (RAID 1).
- **An external disk or NAS** for daily backups, separate from the server.
- **A UPS (battery backup)** for the server and the router.
- **A router or switch** connecting all PCs and phones to the server.
- **One person in the office** who can do basic checks, such as power and the backup disk.

8. What an office server setup can include

None of this is in place yet. Some items need changes to the software, as noted.

- Photos and documents can be stored on the server's own disk instead of a cloud storage service (needs a change to the software).
- The WhatsApp, AI and Zoho screens can be hidden, so nothing in the CRM points to the internet (needs a change to the software).
- User accounts and roles can be created for each team member.
- Automatic daily backups to the external disk can be scheduled.
- Software updates can be applied from a pen drive.
- One person in the office can be shown how to do the routine checks.

9. Next step

Please let us know which option you prefer. The scope, timeline and cost can be confirmed after that.

Hardware figures are a suggested starting point and can be adjusted once the number of users is confirmed.